

Component 3: Appraising

Overview

The purpose of this component is for students to develop their listening and appraising skills through the study of music across a variety of styles and genres. The content is grouped into six areas of study, each of which contains two set works, with the exception of Popular Music and Jazz, which has three set works.

This component gives students the opportunity to reflect on, analyse and evaluate music in aural and/or written form. To achieve this objective they need to use their knowledge and understanding of musical elements, context and language to make critical judgements about the repertoire and context of music within the areas of study. These critical judgements will require the use of specific music vocabulary associated with a particular style or genre.

Students will learn the content of musical elements, context and language through six compulsory areas of study. The areas of study and set works are given on the next page.

Area of study	Set works
Vocal Music	• J. S. Bach, Cantata, Ein feste Burg, BWV 80: Movements 1, 2, 8 • Vaughan Williams, On Wenlock Edge: Nos. 1, 3 and 5 (On Wenlock Edge, Is my team ploughing? and Bredon Hill)
Instrumental Music	• Clara Wieck-Schumann, Piano Trio in G minor, Op. 17: movement 1 • Berlioz, Symphonie Fantastique: Movement I
Music for Film	• Danny Elfman, Batman Returns: Birth of a Penguin Parts I and II, Batman vs the Circus, The Rise and Fall from Grace • Bernard Herrmann, Psycho: Prelude, The City, Marion, The Murder (Shower Scene), The Toys, The Cellar, Discovery, Finale
Popular Music and Jazz	• Kate Bush, Hounds of Love: Cloudbusting, And dream of sheep, and Under ice • Beatles, Revolver: Eleanor Rigby, Here, there and everywhere, I want to tell you, and Tomorrow never knows • Courtney Pine, Back in the Day: Inner state (of mind), Lady Day and (John Coltrane), and Love and affection
Fusions	• Debussy, Estampes: Nos. 1 and 2 (Pagodes and La soirée dans Grenade) • Anoushka Shankar, Breathing Under Water: Burn, Breathing Under Water and Easy
New Directions	• Kaija Saariaho, Petals for Violoncello and Live Electronics • Stravinsky, The Rite of Spring: Introduction, The Augurs of Spring, and Ritual of Abduction

Full details of the exact versions of the scores and recordings for each set work is available on the Pearson website.

There are two set works in each area of study, with the exception of Popular Music and Jazz, which has three set works. The set works will provide students with depth of knowledge of musical elements, language and context.

Other pieces of music

Students should also study a range of pieces beyond these set works. The suggested pieces of other music for each area of study (see *Appendix 4*) provide students with breadth, enabling them to place their knowledge of musical elements, context and language in a wider context, and apply their knowledge and understanding to more pieces of music. Teachers may recommend the pieces listed in *Appendix 4* or they may make their own selection to supplement the areas of study. Please see '*Suggested pieces of other music and unfamiliar pieces*' section for further information.

Content

Knowledge and understanding

Students develop their listening and appraising skills through the study of music across a variety of styles and genres. Students will engage critically with music and develop an understanding of the place of music in different cultures and contexts. The skills of musical analysis and evaluation of music in aural and written form are core to this component.

These skills will be developed through attentive listening coupled with acute aural perception skills. Analysis of the key musical elements will lead to an understanding of genres, styles and traditions, students will demonstrate specialist musical vocabulary and notation skills. With these skills, the expected outcome is the ability to discern the relationship between compositional devices and musical techniques.

Students need to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of musical elements, contexts and language in relation to the music they have studied, and to unfamiliar music for each of the areas of study. They need to analyse and evaluate music in written and aural form in order to make critical judgements about its musical elements, context and language within the scope of its area of study.

These skills are developed through a study of repertoire in the set works. The unfamiliar music questions test the ability of students to relate their learning to other pieces in a similar style or genre. They will be expected to formulate critical judgements, too, on both familiar and unfamiliar music and in doing this to show an understanding of the complexity of the interdependencies of musical elements.

The knowledge and understanding of the study of the set works and other musical pieces is achieved primarily through an in-depth examination and exploration of the musical elements and their interdependence. In addition, placing the music in its intended context and the use of appropriate musical knowledge will deepen understanding.

Students will be required to demonstrate the ability to:

- analyse and evaluate music in aural and written form, using knowledge and understanding of musical elements, musical contexts and musical language to make critical judgements about:
 - repertoire within the areas of study
 - musical interpretations (for example how a performer plays a piece of music, how a composer responds to a brief or a starting point, or demonstration of stylistic understanding)
 - others' work including unfamiliar music (i.e. individual pieces of music that have not been stipulated within the specification)
- formulate critical judgements, achieved through attentive listening (rather than just hearing) and aural perception, and could also be achieved by informed discussion (in writing and/or through speech), analysis, evaluation, contextualisation and reflection
- comment on music heard, showing understanding through the genres, styles and traditions studied
- comment in detail on music heard, showing critical understanding across the genres, styles and traditions studied
- use acute aural perception and discrimination skills
- use appropriate technical musical vocabulary to communicate sophisticated judgements
- show understanding of the complex interdependencies between musical elements
- show understanding of the sophisticated connections between music and its context.

Students will also be required to apply practically, knowledge and understanding of:

- specialist musical vocabulary and notation appropriate to the context
- the relationship between compositional devices and techniques, musical elements, including harmonic progressions, tonal relationships and musical structures appropriate to the context.

Musical elements

Organisation of pitch (melodically and harmonically)

- Harmonic change, cadences, for example interrupted, and melodic and harmonic devices.
- Complex chord progressions, for example the use of secondary dominant, and melodic devices, for example augmentation.

As well as the study of how melodic lines are constructed and common melodic devices, such as sequence, inversion, etc., the study of the harmony in the music is an equally important feature. On a basic level this includes the repertoire and types of chords as well as their use in formulaic cadential progressions. Harmonic devices and more complex chord progressions too should be studied, such as circle of fifths, the use of the secondary dominants, etc.

Tonality

- How keys are related to each other, for example circle of fifths.
- Complex and remote key relationships, for example enharmonic.

In essence, this is the key structure of the music and is often related to the music's form or structure. The relationship between keys is a vital component, such as the relative major/minor, dominant, dominant of the dominant, etc. It is expected that the study of the set works will encompass complex key relationships and enharmonic change.

Structure (organisation of musical material)

- Complex structures, for example sonata form.
- Increasingly complex structures, for example fugue and through-composed music.

The knowledge of the form or structure of music is inherent in the understanding of the composition as a whole. Students will encounter complex structures in the set works, such as sonata form, arch form, fugue, etc. It is through the understanding of the music's structure that the organisation of melody and harmony makes sense and shows again the independence of the musical elements.

Sonority

- Combinations of vocal timbres and instrumental techniques, for example con sordino.
- Further combinations of vocal timbres and instrumental techniques, for example sul ponticello.

This includes an understanding of how sounds might be altered such as con sordini, sul ponticello, flutter tonguing, etc. It also requires an understanding of how combinations of instruments and/or voices create different sonorities.

Texture

- Complex combinations of musical lines (parts), for example homophony and polyphony.
- More complex applications of these, for example fugue.

This element encompasses common textures of monophony, homophony, polyphony, heterophony and fugue. Students should also be able to comment on interesting textural features in the music they study.

Tempo, metre and rhythm (how music is organised in time)

- Metrical and rhythmic devices, for example changing metres and syncopation.
- Complex metrical and rhythmic devices, for example additive rhythm and polyrhythms.

As well as general observations regarding these features, students need to study more-complex metrical and rhythmic devices, such as additive rhythms, cross rhythms and polyrhythms. Many of the more complex uses of these elements will feature in the 20th-century areas of study.

Dynamics (use of dynamics)

- Expressive devices, for example contrast and extended ranges.
- Refined control of dynamics and extreme ranges.

The expressive use of dynamics to enhance music and how this relates to the elements listed above.

These musical elements can be applied to many different types of music but may not be applicable to every single area of study or set work to the same degree or extent. The use of the musical elements above should be used to understand, as appropriate to each area of study and set work, to identify:

- how instrumentation is used in different combinations (identifying instruments and groups of instruments)
- how instrumentation is used to good effect, including playing techniques, etc. associated with a particular instrument or group
- musical and melodic devices (ornamentation, ostinati, riffs, use of imitation, pedal point and sequence)
- rhythmic devices and features (syncopation, swung rhythms, dotted rhythms and triplets), and discriminate between major, minor, modal, pentatonic, chromatic tonalities
- how texture is used, including how the music exploits textural contrasts, with reference to monophony, homophony, polyphony, heterophony, etc.
- how harmony and chord patterns are used in the music.

Musical contexts

- The effect of purpose and intention (for example of the composer, performer, commissioner) on how music is created, developed and performed in different historical, social and cultural contexts.
- The effect of audience, time and place (for example venue, occasion) on how music is created, developed and performed in different historical, social and cultural contexts.
- How music from different historical, social and cultural contexts has changed over time.

Musical language

This includes:

- reading and writing staff notation, including rhythmic notation in compound and irregular time and all key signatures
- chords and associated chord symbols including standard harmonic progressions, for example chord inversions, dominant 7th chords and extended chords, for example secondary 7ths and 9ths
- musical vocabulary and terminology related to the Areas of Study including recognition and use of appropriate musical vocabulary and terminology, for example glissando, repetition and conjunct and recognition and use of sophisticated terminology, for example portamento, and ascending minor scale.

Students need to have a grasp of key stylistic features and be able to use appropriate music language and terminology in their answers. For example, students should be able to describe a repetitive melody in a classical piece as an 'ostinato' but also be able to use the correct term of 'riff' when describing the same feature in a piece of popular music.

In describing musical textures, the description of 'thick' or 'thin' is not appropriate in the description of a homophonic or polyphonic passage. Given the concentration of thirteen set works, it should be possible to ensure the correct and appropriate use of language and terminology.

The Music Vocabulary List in *Appendix 3* provides a list of vocabulary and terminology that supports the learning of musical elements, context and language. This list indicates the level and scope of technical language we would expect from students at this level. The list is not exhaustive. The words listed may appear in the question paper and students should therefore understand them.

Reading and writing staff notation

Some of the study of the set works will involve identifying key musical themes, chord patterns and rhythms. Examination questions every year will feature musical dictation, which could be completing some notes on staff notation/guitar tablature, or identifying a particular rhythm or completing a chord sequence. It is, therefore, important that students study the various types of notation used in the set works.

Areas of study

Students will learn the musical elements, context and language in depth through the six compulsory areas of study, each of which consist of set works and other musical pieces.

Areas of study give students a focus to demonstrate in-depth knowledge, understanding and skills. The areas of study encompass repertoire that allows the musical elements, musical contexts and musical language to be taught in context, and provide opportunities for students to demonstrate contextual understanding through their performing and composing.

The areas of study are:

- Vocal Music
- Instrumental music
- Music for Film
- Popular Music and Jazz
- Fusions
- New Directions.

Teachers should enable students to draw connections and links between the set works within each area of study and also to explore the connections with the other areas of study and other musical pieces. They can also draw on set works in other areas of study.

Area of Study 1 – Vocal Music

The pieces selected as set works provide a variety of vocal works from this area of study. These range from a Baroque Bach Cantata, as a sacred work designed for church performance, to *On Wenlock Edge* by Vaughan Williams, a 20th-century work providing breadth to the study of vocal works.

Appendix 4 provides a background and context to the set works. As a complement to the sacred Bach Cantata, there is an extract an Oratorio, *Messiah* by Handel. The Schubert and Mendelssohn lieder are examples of Romantic forms of writing for solo voice that provide background for comparisons to the vocal settings in *On Wenlock Edge*. Romantic operas by Wagner and Verdi show developments in this genre from the Classical operas of Mozart.